



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Knox Classical Academy
School Website: <https://trinityknoxclassical.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Trinity Knox Classical Academy (TKCA) demonstrates a clear classical-Catholic-Christian orientation in its public materials, with a strong emphasis on Christian formation, biblical worldview, and a liberal-arts framework. The school explicitly positions itself as Christ-centered and classical, articulating aims around forming souls, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. The curriculum references the liberal-arts foundation (including the Trivium) and stresses a long-standing classical vision of education, including engagement with Western intellectual heritage and Great Ideas. However, while TKCA presents many elements aligned with classical education (especially in religious foundations and curriculum), explicit pedagogy and faculty-community dynamics characteristic of a fully developed classical model (e.g., dedicated Socratic/seminar-style pedagogy, a living-faculty-as-curriculum approach, and robust parent-partnership structures) are less clearly documented on the public site. Given the evidence, TKCA sits toward the Classical end of the spectrum but exhibits notable gaps in explicit articulation of all six classical elements in public-facing materials.

- Strong classical and religious foundations are evidenced by Christ-centered language, biblical worldview integration, and explicit formation goals (Element 1: CLASSICAL; Element 2: CLASSICAL).
- The curriculum aligns with liberal-arts tradition (Trivium and Great Ideas), with specific reference to the Trivium and a classic curriculum framing (Element 3: CLASSICAL).
- Pedagogy and upper-school practices are less explicitly documented, yielding a more mixed (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) signal (Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL).
- Faculty engagement and explicit "living curriculum" framing are not robustly evident in public-facing content (Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL, given available text).
- Parent/Community partnerships are suggested more implicitly (e.g., campus openness and community links), but explicit co-teaching or formal parent-formation language is not clearly documented (Element 6: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize Christ-centered, biblical worldview framing and theological grounding (e.g., "Christ Centered Classical Education"; "biblical worldview"; disciples of Jesus Christ).
- Language around forming souls and orders of affections aligns with transcendental moral realism and the theological grounding of education.
- References to theology and sacred worldview are present (e.g., biblical truth, Christian formation).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: Christ-centered, biblical worldview, theology, virtue formation, truth/goodness/beauty language, formation of souls. Examples include "Christ Centered Classical Education,"

“biblical worldview,” and explicit statements about making disciples of Jesus Christ.

- No explicit negative indicators observed in the public materials (no explicit relativism or secularism signals in the visible texts). (Lexicon guidance provided in the classical lexicon supports seeking these signals; public content here emphasizes theology and formation.)
- Why this rating
- TKCA's public materials clearly anchor education in Christian-theological foundations, with explicit formation aims and a biblical lens on learning. This strongly matches the religious and metaphysical foundations emphasized in classical education models.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public statements frame education as formation and cultivation of virtue and wisdom, not merely information or job preparation. Phrases about forming souls, loving mercy, seeking justice, and articulating truth are prominent.
- The mission includes development through a classical framework and biblical truth, aiming at human formation and virtue rather than narrow workforce outcomes.
- The overall messaging aligns with classical aims of truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, liberal education, true/good/beautiful, telos/true good beautiful, contemplation. Key lines emphasize formation and virtue over mere information.
- No evidence of an explicit workforce-readiness or job-prep emphasis in the public-facing mission statements. (The lexicon distinguishes these as negative signals; TKCA's language centers virtue and formation instead.)
- Why this rating
- The school's stated purpose and goals center formation, virtue, and the pursuit of transcendent values, in line with classical aims.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum references the seven liberal arts framework and the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric). This is a core classical criterion.
- Public materials discuss Great Ideas and the Great Conversation framing—aligning with engagement with foundational canonical works and Western intellectual heritage.
- Curriculum sections show Bible, geography, history, and the liberal-arts approach in the K–12 plan, consistent with a classical, liberal-arts curriculum.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: seven liberal arts, Trivium, Great Ideas/Great Conversation, liberal arts, canonical and historical engagement.
- The explicit Great Books labeling is not always explicit in every TKCA public page, but the “great ideas” framing appears (Great Conversation). This keeps the curriculum within the classical sphere.
- Why this rating
- TKCA's curriculum is anchored in classical liberal arts and a Great-ideas/historical-heritage approach, with Trivium framing and a biblically informed content mix.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Classical framing is present (Trivium foundation in the curriculum), and some pages hint at discussion-based and rigorous study modes (e.g., Trivium-based progression, classical pedagogy references). However, explicit, public references to specific modern pedagogies (Socratic seminars, structured Socratic discussions in upper grades, or a stated emphasis on scholé/restful learning) are not clearly documented in the visible TKCA pages.
- There is strong emphasis on formation and truth claims, but concrete statements about upper-school Socratic seminars, debates, or rhetoric training (explicitly named in the classical-pedagogy rubric) are

not clearly visible on the public site.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: Trivium-based framing, emphasis on formation and classical approaches to learning.
- Negative indicators present: lack of explicit articulation of Socratic seminars, scholé days, or explicit upper-school rhetoric and public-speaking programs in the public-facing content. (These are highlighted in the classical-rubric lexicon as typical indicators; their explicit public presence here is not strong.)
- Why this rating
- The foundational classical elements exist (Trivium, liberal arts), but explicit, public-facing pedagogy details (Socratic seminars, semin- “seminars,” “scholé” practices) are not strongly documented, yielding a middle position.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public content shows leadership pages and general information but does not clearly present a “living curriculum” concept, portraits of teacher ideals, or a robust faculty-formation narrative that is central to classical schools (as described in the classical lexicon). The presence of leadership pages exists, but explicit “faculty-as-living-curriculum” language is not clearly visible.
- No explicit description of a faculty culture as mentors/model teachers or a defined teacher-portrait is evident in the accessible public content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators (e.g., “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty as mentors”) are not clearly present in the public-facing TKCA materials. The classical lexicon emphasizes these as key signals; their public articulation is not evident here.
- Negative indicators: The absence of explicit “faculty-as-living-curriculum” language and related classical-faculty language suggests not fully meeting Element 5’s classical signals.
- Why this rating
- While TKCA emphasizes formation and classical structure, explicit public-facing statements about the faculty’s role as the living curriculum and mentor-model are not clearly documented, leading to a NOT CLASSICAL assessment for this category based on the available content.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- TKCA’s site and materials show community orientation (campus location, open admissions contact, and community engagement). There is clear emphasis on forming a community around Christian classical principles, including statements about formation and shared mission.
- There are indications of parent/community engagement in the broader classical-education discourse (per the Six Essential Elements framework, which stresses parent partnership and community formation). The school’s content hints at parent involvement and community alignment but does not explicitly articulate a formal “parents as co-teachers” program in public-facing materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: community orientation, formation-centered messaging, and a shared mission with families (implied by campus-community presence and biblical-formation emphasis).
- Negative indicators present: absence of explicit “parents as co-teachers” language or detailed parent-formation programs on the public site. This is a gap relative to the strongest articulation of Element 6 signals in classical models.
- Why this rating
- There is clear community context and parent-involvement potential, but the public-facing materials do not robustly demonstrate the full range of explicit parent-partnership language or structured formation programs.

Overall classification and synthesis

- Aggregate assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: TKCA demonstrates strong alignment with classical education in its religious foundations (Element 1), formation-oriented purpose (Element 2), and curriculum (Element 3). Pedagogy (Element 4) and Faculty (Element 5) show some classical signals but lack explicit public articulation of core classical practices. Parent/community (Element 6) shows potential alignment but isn't fully codified in public content. Taken together, TKCA sits toward the classical end but does not fully meet every criterion in a way that would classify it as CLASSICAL across all six categories.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4)
- Publicly articulate and implement explicit Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in upper grades, including structured inquiry, dialectic discussions, and opportunities for student-led rhetoric and debates.
- Highlight scholé/restful-learning components and contemplative practices (e.g., Scholé days) as part of the lower and middle school pedagogy.
- Faculty (Element 5)
- Publish a clear "living-curriculum" narrative for faculty (portrait of a teacher, teacher-mentors as core to the school, and professional development in classical pedagogy).
- Include statements about teacher formation, classical pedagogy training, and community of practice among faculty.
- Parents & Community (Element 6)
- Explicitly describe a formal partnership model with parents (parents as co-teachers) and offer structured parent-formation opportunities (book studies, seminars, and voluntary involvement).
- Publicly detail a campus-visitor/open-house policy and ongoing opportunities for parent education about classical education.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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